

Answer the following questions.

i) Kashmir is known for its handicrafts. Discuss?

Ans: The Handicrafts of Kashmir have acquired worldwide fame for their exquisite refinement and aesthetic elegance. These crafts have great diversity and demand. The Kashmiri handicraft includes the making of qaleens, paper machie, embroidery, metal ware, wicker work, leather and wood carving. The finished products are exported all over the world.

ii) Discuss the mineral based industries of Jammu and Kashmir?

Ans: Many mineral based industries have been established in both public and private sector. The Wuyan Cement Factory is the largest cement supplier to the Valley of Kashmir. This cement factory was established in 1962 to which raw material is supplied from Uri and Baramulla areas. This factory provides employment to about 275 workers and produces about 2,000 tonnes of cement annually. In 1982, a large cement factory was established at Khrew. This factory is known as the J&K Cements Ltd, Khrew. There are more than 500 workers employed in this factory producing about 600 tonnes of cement a day. Besides bricks and tile factories are also located at varied locations over the regions. A modern industrial centre is fast emerging at Bari Brahamna Jammu which has provided boost to the manufacturing sector in J&K.

iii) Write a short note on the agro based industry of Jammu, Kashmir and Ladakh?

Ans: Jammu and Kashmir is an agrarian economy, and agro based industry is the most important industry. Paddy is produced in large quantities in this region. A modern rice plant has been established at

Lethpora Pulwama in 1981. Horticulture is also well established in the valley. Fruits such as apples, cherries, apricots etc. are exported in large quantities, and also have a well-developed infrastructure for producing finished products like jams, juice and beverages in and around Srinagar, Sopore and Bari Brahamana. Many cold storage chains have been established in Lassipora Pulwama, Srinagar and Jammu regions.

iv) Write a short note on the tourism industry of Jammu, Kashmir and Ladakh?

Ans: Tourism Industry is being considered as the backbone of the economy for Jammu, Kashmir and Ladakh. The beautiful valleys, snow clad peaks, lakes and springs, attracts people from all over the world. Besides archaeological, cultural, religious places offer the opportunities for trekking, mountaineering, skiing etc. The growth of adventure tourism and cable car projects provide large employment opportunities across the regions especially in the hospitality sector.

v) Write a short note on 'Paper Machie'?

Ans: The word 'papier-mâché' has come to be identified as the art of Kashmir. The papier-mâché technique of using paper pulp for making decorative objects was first adopted in Kashmir in the 15th century by King Zain-ul-Abidin. The skilled artisans involved with this painstaking process are called sakhta makers. The materials involved with this process are discarded paper, cloth, straw of rice plant, copper sulfate, which are mixed and made into a pulp. The paper, after immersing in water for 4–5 weeks, is taken out and made into a pulp and dried. The dried paper is then converted to a powder. There is also a practice to mix the powdered paper with rice water to facilitate coagulation. The pulp thus made is applied on molds made

in wood or brass and colourful designs are painted on them. The centres of production include Rainawari in Srinagar and Anantnag Districts.